

All, each, every, and none

Teaching guide

Describe a whole group or its individual members.

Understand the distinction

All usually treats the group together: All the students are here. Each and every normally take a singular noun and singular verb: Each student has a book; every room is ready. Each highlights individuals; every emphasizes the whole set.

Use each of the students, not every of the students. None of takes a plural or uncountable noun phrase. With a plural noun, either singular or plural agreement can occur depending on meaning and style: None of the seats is/are free.

Compare the patterns

GROUP

All the rooms are ready.

The rooms are considered together.

INDIVIDUALS

Each room has a key.

Consider the rooms one by one.

ZERO

None of the water is clean.

The uncountable water takes is.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. Complete: Every student ___ a notebook. (has / have)

- A. have
- B. having
- C. has

2. Choose the correction: Every of the rooms is ready.

- A. Every of the rooms are ready.
- B. Each of the rooms is ready.
- C. Each of the room is ready.

3. Must None of the seats are free always be changed to is?

- A. Yes. None always requires a singular verb.
- B. No. None of the seats means all the seats are free.
- C. No. Plural agreement is accepted with a plural noun.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Every student has a pencil, and there are no calculators in the group. Which pair states this correctly?

- A. Every student has a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.
- B. Every student have a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.
- C. Every student has a pencil. All of the students have a calculator.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. has

Every + singular noun normally takes a singular verb.

A: Every student takes singular agreement: has.

B: This sentence needs a finite verb: has.

2. B. Each of the rooms is ready.

Alternatively: Every room is ready.

A: Every of is not the pattern. Use each of or every room.

C: After each of the, use the plural noun rooms.

3. C. No. Plural agreement is accepted with a plural noun.

Meaning and style can guide the choice.

A: With a plural noun, plural agreement with none is accepted.

B: None of the seats are free means there are no free seats.

4. A. Every student has a pencil. None of the students has a calculator.

Every student takes has. None of the students has a calculator is acceptable; have is also possible after none of the students.

B: Every student requires singular has.

C: The second sentence contradicts the stated absence of calculators.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-23.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Every student has a pencil, and there are no calculators in the group. Which pair states this correctly?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.